



First, Next, Last

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children put the steps of an action in order — first, next, last. Ordering steps is the foundation of sequencing and algorithms: a plan is a list of steps that must happen in the right order.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children order the steps of a familiar process.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child circles and writes 1-2-3.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil. Optional: real blocks to build the 1-2-3 tower in order first.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: build the tower aloud — 'first one block, next two, last three.' The number of blocks grows.
2. GUIDED: Exercise 1 — the step with one dot comes first (fewest).
3. YOU TRY: children find the LAST step (Ex 2), then number all three in order (Ex 3).
4. Connect: 'A plan made of ordered steps is called an algorithm — computers follow algorithms.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Model — first 1 block, next 2 blocks, last 3 blocks.

Ex 1 — circle the single dot • (fewest = first).

Ex 2 — circle the three dots • • • (most = last).

Ex 3 — order is: • = 1, • • = 2, • • • = 3.

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: ordering by position on the page instead of by count — have them count the dots aloud.

Simplify: order just two steps (1 then 2) before three.

Extend: add a fourth step (4 dots) and re-order, or order steps of a real routine.

Movement option: line up children shortest to tallest — that is putting things in order too.

Success looks like

The child identifies the first and last steps by count and numbers the three steps 1-2-3 in order.